LAF YOMI

Bekhorot 57 · November 14, 2026

ON TODAY'S DAF

Maaser behemah, continued. Brothers who divide and recombine: is the old tefusat habayit back, or a new partnership? R. Yochanan says no bereirah, and the Gemara tests him with partners who split nineteen goats and a dog. Then the Mishnah's exclusions: kilayim, treifah, C-section births, the under-eight-days, and the orphan — plus the baraita's inclusions, from the dog's price to the tumtum. The daf closes with tall tales and the three gathering seasons.

BEREIRAH · THE YOVEL SWAP THAT KEEPS BROTHERS HONEST



1. R. Yochanan rules that brothers who divide their father's estate are buyers — so at Yovel they must give everything back. The acharonim offer three readings of 'they return to each other at Yovel.'

“Maharshal: re-divide. Penei Yehoshua: a ceremony. The SMaG: they swap — Reuven takes Shimon's share, Shimon takes Reuven's. 'Very geshmak' — everybody stays honest.”

— Rabbi Moshe Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 57a · the Yovel return — מחזירים זה לזה ביובל · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 10:31

MECHIR KELEV · THE PIT-BULL GUILT OFFERING



2. The baraita: two partners split nineteen goats and a dog — ten goats to one, nine goats and the dog to the other. The goat matching the dog can't be offered: mechir kelev. But why is a dog's price unfit for the altar?

“Ibn Ezra: it's a disgrace. Ramban: people bought pit bulls that did serious damage, then brought a korban to clear their conscience. 'We don't want this korban.”

— Rabbi Moshe Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 57a · the dog's price — מחיר כלב · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 14:51

BEREIRAH · THE ONE-PIECE KASHRUT SHORTCUT



3. If bereirah works — retroactive designation — Tosafot asks why it can't fix kashrut: non-kosher falls into kosher, why not just pick up one piece and declare that the non-kosher one?

“Tosafot's answer: a ta'arovet isn't a mixture problem, it's a mixture event — the issur is that the mixture happened. Deeper still: at sixty-to-one it's not a mixture in the first place.”

— Rabbi Moshe Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 57a · Rav Ashi's answer — אי דשוו כולהו אהדדי · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 19:44

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MAASER BEHEMAH · EVERYBODY'S MOTHER DIES EVENTUALLY



4. The Mishnah: an orphan — an animal whose mother died or was slaughtered before it was fully born — doesn't enter the pen to be tithed. But what exactly counts as an orphan?

“The mefarshim: certainly not a calf born while its mother was alive whose mother died later — 'that's not called an orphan, because everybody's mother is ultimately going to die.' An orphan is only one whose mother died in childbirth, before the baby was completely born.”

— Rabbi Moshe Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 57a · what is an orphan? — איזהו יתום · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 22:05

TUMTUM · THE SEX GOD KNOWS



5. The baraita: a tumtum — its signs covered — and an androgynus — signs of both — do enter the pen to be tithed. R. Shimon ben Yehuda disagrees: they don't. What is a tumtum, that the Tanna can't decide?

“The Tanna holds it's a safek: 'We don't know if it's a male or it's a female... but God knows if it's a male or a female.' Since God knows, it's certainly obligated — like all other males and females.”

— Rabbi Moshe Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 57a · tumtum and androgynus — ספקא הוא · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 31:55

TALL TALES · THE EGG THAT DROWNED SIXTY CITIES



6. R. Yishmael ben Satriel testifies about his hometown: the lettuce there has 600,000 leaves in its core, and once a cedar fell so wide that sixteen wagons crossed its trunk side by side. Then: once the bar yokhani bird's egg fell — and drowned sixty cities and shattered three hundred cedars.

“The Gemara objects: the bird never drops its eggs — the verse says its wing 'rejoices' aloft. Rav Ashi: that one was a spoiled egg. That's why it dropped. Sixty cities, three hundred cedars — all because of one rotten egg.”

— Rabbi Moshe Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 57b · the bar yokhani egg — נפלה ביעא בר יוכני · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 40:25